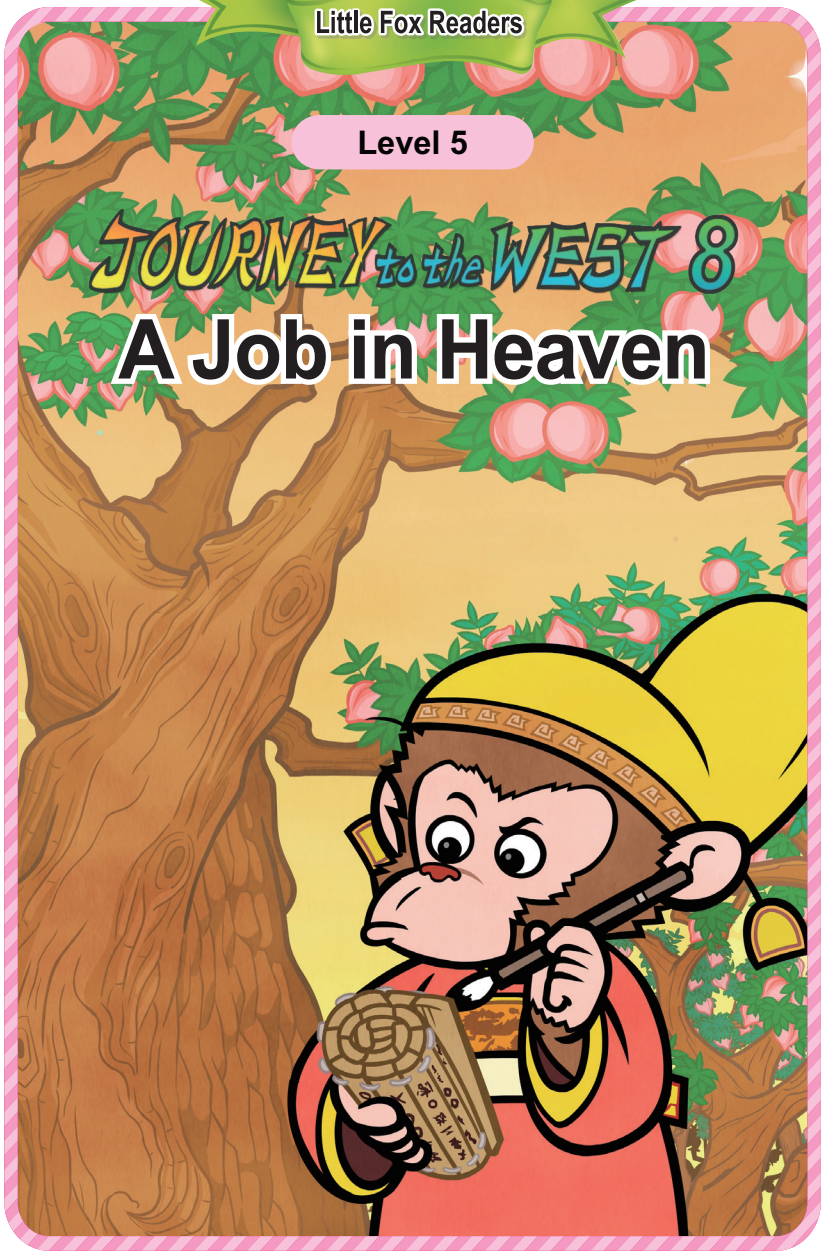
Little Fox Readers

Level 5

JOURNEY to the WEST 8

A Job in Heaven



Little Fox



The Jade Emperor was sitting on his throne in the Cloud Palace.

A messenger ran into the court. "Your Majesty," he said. "The Dragon King of the Eastern Sea is here to see you."

"Let him in," said the emperor.

The Dragon King entered and bowed. "Your Majesty, I want to make a complaint. Sun Wukong came to my palace and

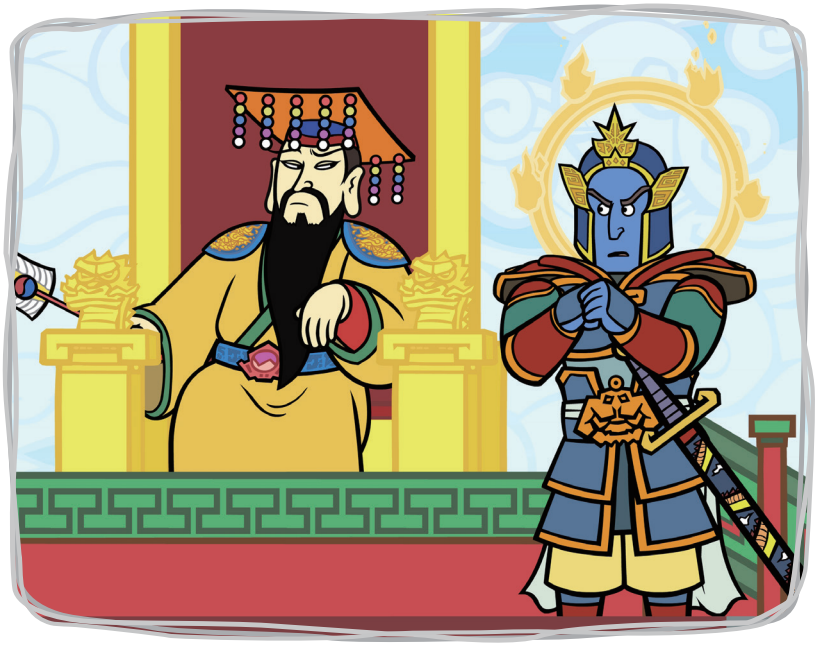


demanded I give him a weapon. He was very rude."

Another messenger came in. "The Judge of the Dead would like to speak with you, Your Majesty."

The judge came in and bowed. "A monkey named Sun Wukong crossed out his name in the Directory. I beg you to punish him!"

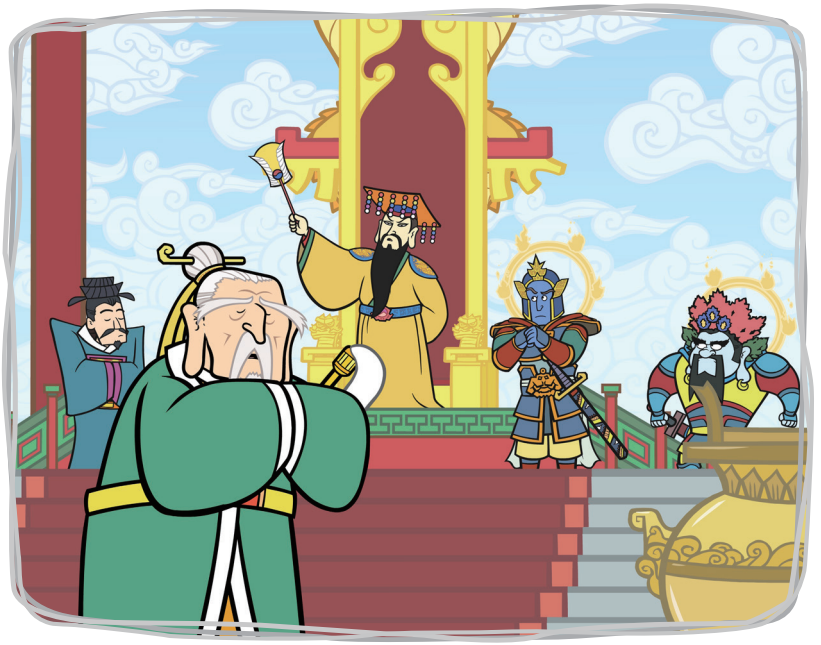
The Jade Emperor rubbed his chin. "Who



is this Sun Wukong? And how did he become so powerful?”

The emperor’s captain stepped forward. “Sun Wukong is the monkey who was born from a rock three hundred years ago. I don’t know how he became so powerful.”

“I remember him,” said the Jade Emperor. “I don’t care how powerful he is. He is causing too much trouble on Earth. Gather



some troops, and go down to the Fruit and Flower Mountain. I want Sun Wukong arrested!"

The spirit of the planet Venus stepped forward.

"Your Majesty," said Venus. "Perhaps we could give Wukong a job here in Heaven."

The Jade Emperor raised his eyebrows. "Why would we do that?"



“If he’s here, we can keep an eye on him,” said Venus. “It will be easy to keep him out of trouble.”

“Very well,” said the emperor. “Invite Wukong to come to live in Heaven. He will be in charge of the Royal Peach Garden.”

* * *

Wukong was telling his subjects about his



adventure in the Land of Darkness.

"After I crossed out my name," he said, "I crossed out all of your names too. We will all live forever!"

The monkeys and apes cheered. "Hooray for the Monkey King!"

Wukong noticed a spirit standing nearby. He pulled out his iron bar. "Who are you?"

"I am Venus," said the spirit. "I have an



invitation from the Jade Emperor. He would like you to come to live in Heaven."

Wukong smiled. "At last he has invited me."

* * *

When Wukong entered the royal court in the Cloud Palace, he didn't bow.

"You're supposed to bow before the



emperor," whispered Venus.

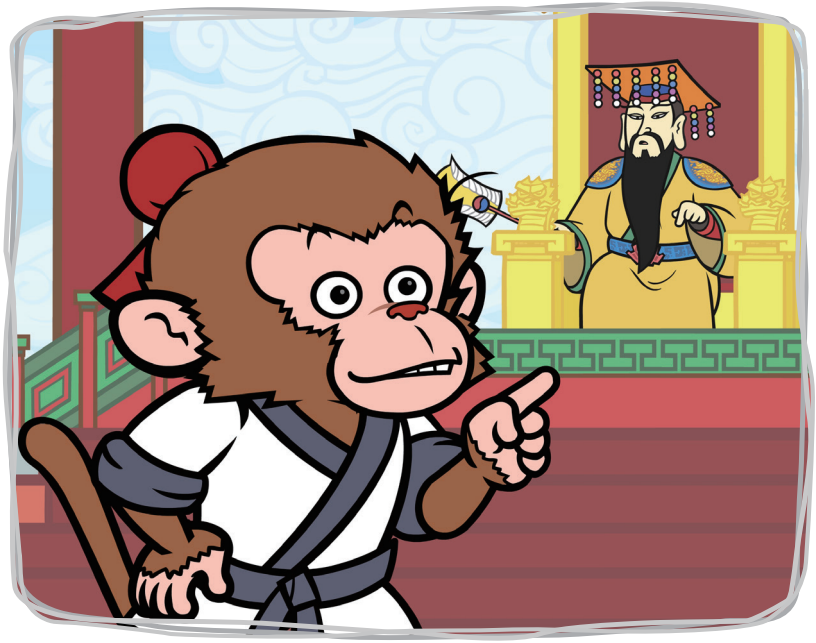
Wukong laughed. "I'm just as powerful as he is. Maybe he should bow before me!"

Everyone but the Jade Emperor gasped.

Wukong looked at the emperor. "I'm glad you invited me. I guess you finally realized I should be living up here with all of you."

"Show some respect," said Venus.

The Jade Emperor looked at Venus and



smiled. “Wukong is new here. He can be excused for not acting the right way.” He looked at Wukong. “I’m putting you in charge of the Royal Peach Garden. You will have a home here in Heaven. I hope you won’t cause any more trouble.”

“That sounds perfect!” said Wukong.

The next morning a gardener showed Wukong the peach garden. Bright, glowing

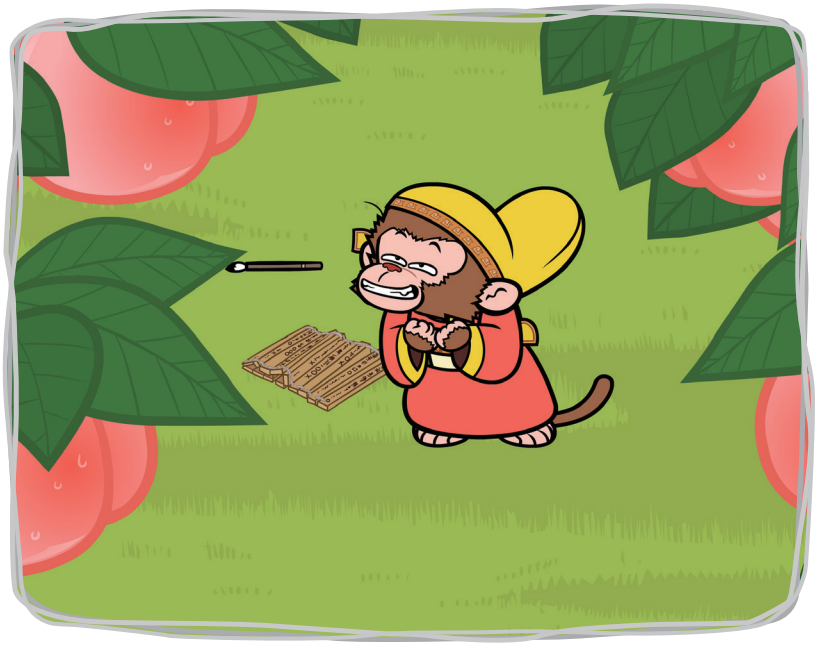


peaches hung from every branch.

"The peaches in this garden are not like peaches on Earth," said the gardener. "These peaches take thousands of years to become ripe. Anybody who takes a bite of one will live forever."

Each morning Wukong inspected the trees in the garden. He took his job very seriously.

"These peaches look delicious," Wukong



thought one day. He looked around. None of the gardeners were in sight. “Maybe I’ll eat one.”

Little Fox Readers

Level 5

Journey to the West 8
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